STAFF GUIDE · BRITISH-GEORGIAN ACADEMY

BGA NEWSLETTER

How to add your stories and events to the weekly parents' newsletter

OPEN IN ANY BROWSER
newsletter.bga.ge

Every week the newsletter is built from what staff add to this platform. You write a story or add an event, the SLT member for your area checks it, marketing lays out the issue and the principal gives the final OK before it goes to parents through Mailchimp. **Nothing is ever sent automatically.**

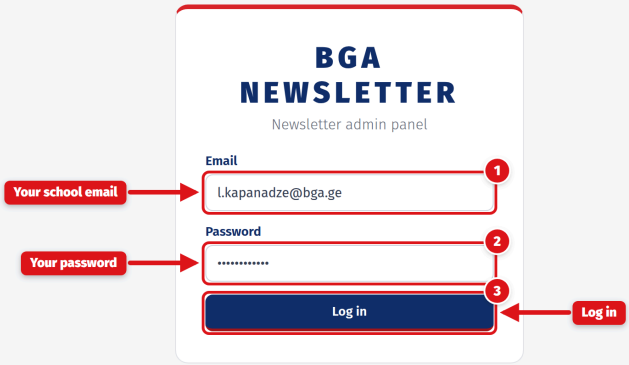
Monday 09:00
Reminder email: "please add your news for this week".

Monday - Thursday
Log in and add stories, photos and events.

Thursday 09:00
Last-call reminder - only if you haven't added anything yet.

Thursday 18:00
Deadline. The issue is assembled; anything added later goes into **next week's** issue.

1 Log in



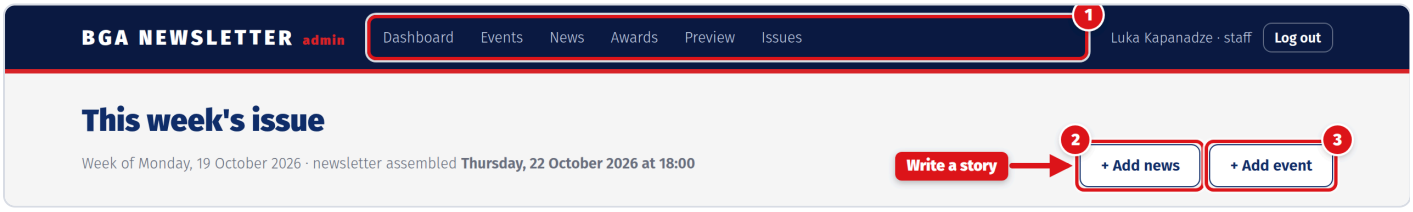
First time? You'll receive an invitation email. Click the link in it, choose a password, and you are signed in straight away.

After that, go to **newsletter.bga.ge** and:

1. Type your **school email** (the one the invitation came to).
2. Type your **password**.
3. Press **Log in**.

Forgot your password or lost the invitation? Ask marketing (or the newsletter admin) to send you a new invitation from the *Users* page. After 10 wrong attempts, log-in pauses for 15 minutes.

2 Your dashboard



1. **The menu.** *News* and *Events* list everything you have added; *Preview* shows the newsletter as it currently looks; *Awards* holds the Primary certificate winners.
2. **+ Add news** - write a story for the newsletter (step 3, next page).
3. **+ Add event** - put a date in the "Upcoming Events" calendar (step 4).

Good to know: you can write a story for **any area** of the school, and you can edit or delete your own stories at any time from the *News* page. Below the buttons the dashboard shows what has been submitted for this week's issue so far.

i Who does what

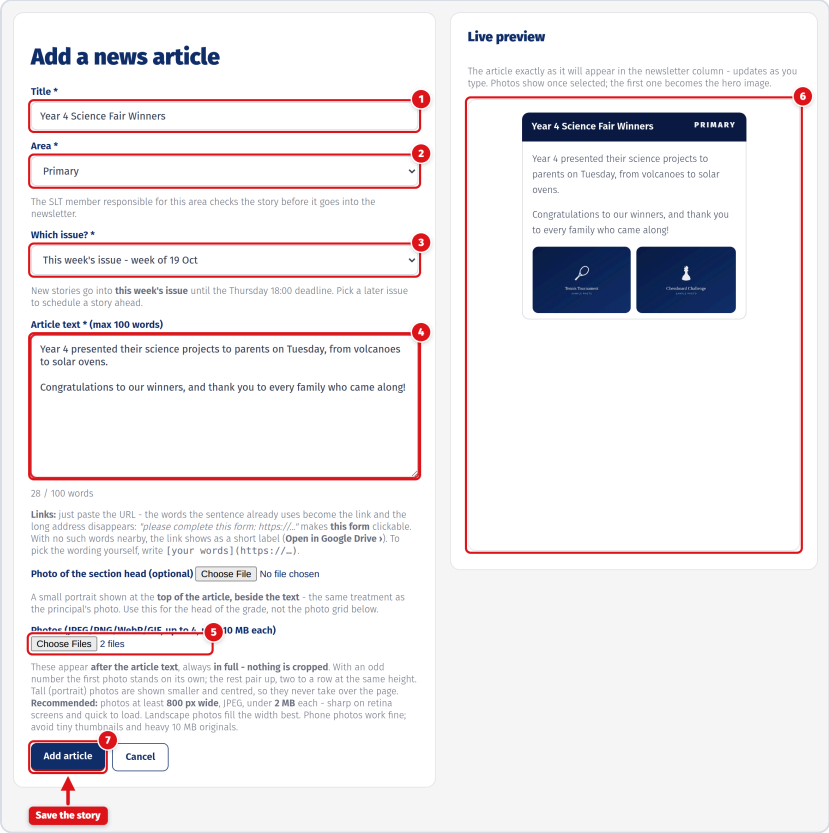
All staff
Teachers and LSAs write stories and add events for any area, and get the Monday and Thursday reminder emails. *Steps 1-4.*

SLT
Check the stories for their own area before they can go in. Also manage staff accounts and settings. *Step 5.*

Marketing
Lay out the issue, polish the text and photos in the live editor, and send the approved draft from Mailchimp. *Step 6.*

Principal
Writes the weekly *Principal's message* and quote (in the menu), then proof-reads and approves the issue. *Step 7.*

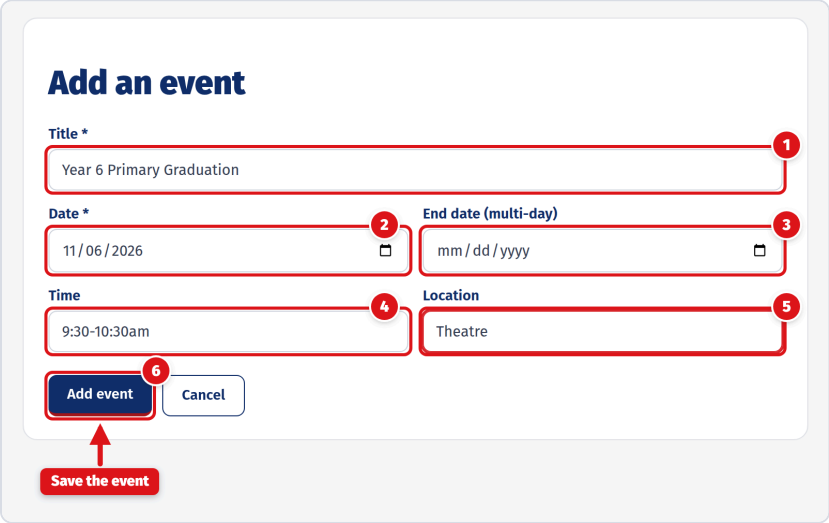
3 Write a news story



1. **Title** - short and specific, e.g. "Year 4 Science Fair Winners".
2. **Area** - Whole School · Primary · Secondary · Sixth Form · Co-Curricular
   The SLT member for that area checks your story before parents see it.
3. **Which issue?** - this week's issue is chosen for you until the Thursday 18:00 deadline. Pick a later week to schedule a story ahead.
4. **Article text** - up to **100 words** (a counter shows how many you have used). Leave an empty line between paragraphs. To add a link, just paste the web address.
5. **Photos** - up to 4, JPEG or PNG. Photos are **never cropped**; landscape photos at least 800 px wide and under 2 MB look best. Phone photos are fine.
6. **Live preview** - your story exactly as it will appear in the newsletter, updating as you type.
7. Press **Add article**. The story is saved as *awaiting check*.

> **After you save:** once the SLT member approves it, the story goes into the issue. If they **send it back**, you'll see their note on the *News* page - edit and save again. Changing the text of an approved story sends it back for a new check.

4 Add an event



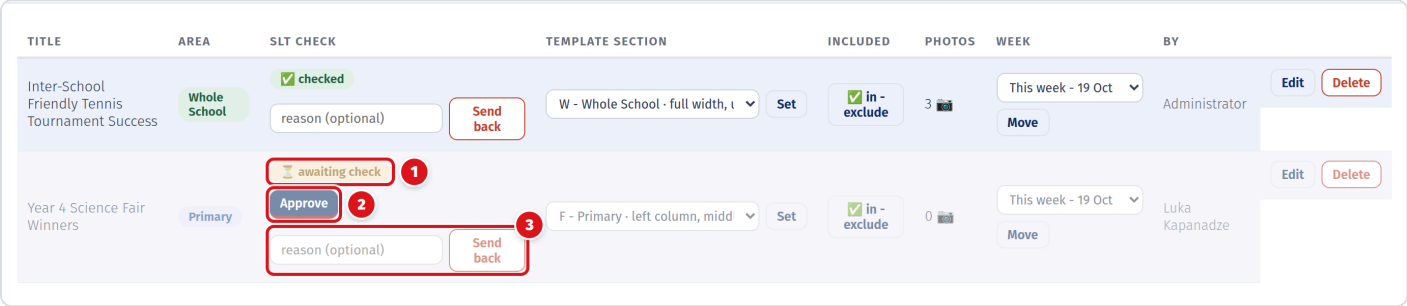
1. **Title** - what is happening, e.g. "Year 6 Primary Graduation".
2. **Date** - the day of the event.
3. **End date** - only for events lasting several days (trips, exam weeks). Leave empty otherwise.
4. **Time** - free text, e.g. "9:30-10:30am" or "All day".
5. **Location** - e.g. "Theatre", "Sports Hall", "Online".
6. Press **Add event**.

> **Where it appears:** events show in the newsletter's **Upcoming Events** calendar, sorted by date, from the week they are added until the day has passed - so add big dates early.

Checking, layout and approval For SLT, marketing and the principal

5 Check the stories for your area

SLT

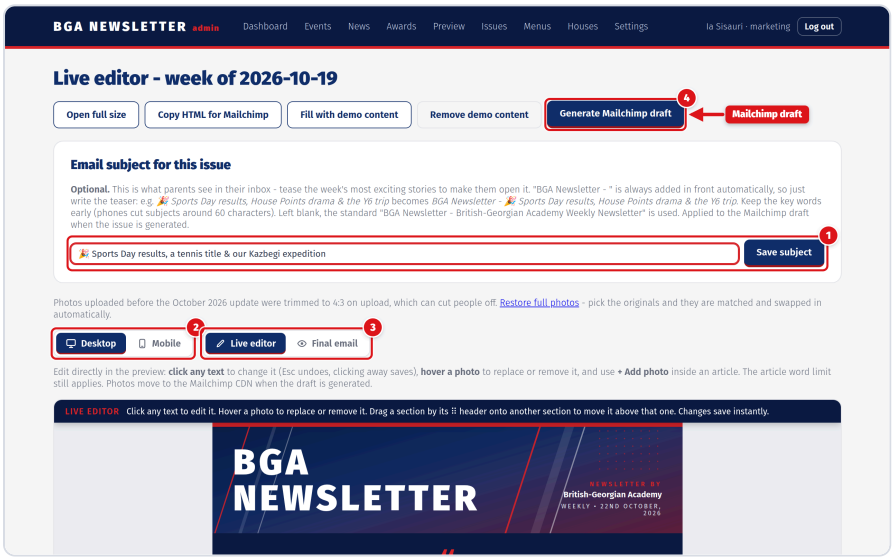


1. New stories for your area show **awaiting check** on the *News* page (and on your dashboard).
2. **Approve** - the story goes into the issue.
3. **Send back** - type a short reason; the author sees it and can fix the story.

Only approved stories reach parents. Anything still waiting at Thursday 18:00 is left out - please check your area by Thursday afternoon.

6 Lay out the issue and create the Mailchimp draft

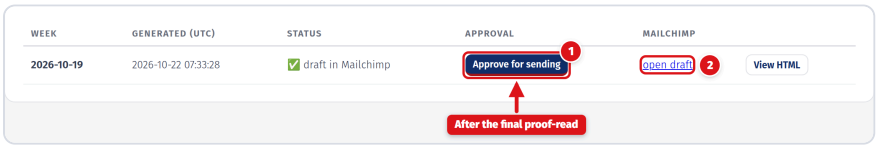
MARKETING



1. **Email subject** - an optional teaser for parents' inboxes; "BGA Newsletter - " is added in front automatically. Press *Save subject*.
2. **Desktop / Mobile** - check the issue on a computer and on a phone-size screen.
3. **Live editor / Final email** - in the live editor click any text to fix it, hover a photo to replace it, drag a section by its header to move it. *Final email* is exactly what parents receive.
4. **Generate Mailchimp draft** - builds the draft in Mailchimp. Runs automatically every Thursday at 18:00; press it again after any late change.

7 Final proof-read and approval

PRINCIPAL



1. On the *Issues* page, press **Approve for sending** after reading the issue. Marketing gets an email that it may go out.
2. **open draft** opens the campaign in Mailchimp, where marketing presses **Send**.

Need help? Contact marketing or the newsletter admin - they can add accounts, resend invitations, move a late story into this week's issue and regenerate the draft.